

Why say that AI burns water if water doesn't even burn ?

Posted by u/Anonnnnnnnnnnnnnnm • 0 points • 22 comments

I can't find one source that supports the claim that water burns up. They use water for it sure, but it is not burned. It steams and enters the atmosphere again.

I understand other issues with AI, but this issue, I do not. Please enlighten me.

Comments

u/crazy010101 • 1 points • 2025-12-26 18:52 UTC

"Burn" in this sense is an adjective describing waste.

u/SwimOk9629 • 2 points • 2025-12-26 18:40 UTC

when someone says they are burning through water, it doesn't literally mean igniting the water on fire. it means running through water, in this situation burning through is a synonym for using up at a fast rate. simple as that.

u/Anonnnnnnnnnnnnnnm • 0 points • 2025-12-27 02:33 UTC

Friend. *I* know that water cannot be burned or lit a flame. Im wondering how folks are getting to the conclusion that AI *actually burns* the water up. My 1 co worker was arguing with 4 other coworkers about how they are a part of the reason AI will burn all the water up and leave nothing.

Where is this misinformation coming from ?? Why would anyone come to that conclusion? I wasn't sure if their was media sources pushing it or if this guy needs a psychiatrist.

u/Loose-Mousse1064 • 1 points • 2025-12-26 18:40 UTC

They don't mean it in a literal sense. People also say things like "burning through money" but they aren't literally burning the money, they are just using it up fast.

u/Anonnnnnnnnnnnnnnm • 1 points • 2025-12-26 20:21 UTC

The argument being had at work is literal. My coworker is arguing with people at work for using AI, saying there will be no water left once AI burns it all up.

u/Loose-Mousse1064 • 1 points • 2025-12-27 00:32 UTC

Are you sure he is arguing that it's literally? Or are you sure assuming he talking literally? Have you ask "do you mean burning up literally as in, with fire or just metaphorically like using alot"?

u/Anonnnnnnnnnnnnnnm • 1 points • 2025-12-27 01:10 UTC

Very literal. The water will be "GONE" because of everyone using AI and burning it up.

At least, according to him. And I don't get his argument bc water can't actually burn, so it's not going away.

u/Loose-Mousse1064 • 1 points • 2025-12-27 01:47 UTC

You didnt answer my question, did you ask him if he meant it literally or metaphorically?

Because water would also be "GONE" if it was used up quickly (i.e burning thorough it quickly in a metaphorical sense) So unless you have literally asked your co-worker if they are talking literally or metaphically then it's just an assumption you are making.

u/Anonnnnnnnnnnnnnnm • 0 points • 2025-12-27 02:30 UTC

I dont to have to ask your specific question to no what he was arguing with them about. He's not fuckin arguing that people should panic that the AI plant's water well runs dry. He's arguing that everyone should panic that AI will use all the water and then burn it up. Its really not hard to understand what he was saying my guy.

u/Loose-Mousse1064 • 1 points • 2025-12-27 02:43 UTC

So in other words, you haven't asked your co worker if they meant literally or metaphorically. I see. Therefore, you are just assuming they meant literally.

At this point you may or may not have assumed correctly. But we will never

know unless you ask as non of the examples you have given conclude without a shadow of doubt that be was speaking literally, everything you have mentioned so far could be assumed either way.

u/Anonnnnnnnnnnnnnnm
• 0 points •
2025-12-27
02:51 UTC

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about as
dense as
he is I think.

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u/AragonGG04 • 1 points • 2025-12-26 18:20 UTC

Classic water cycle taught in schools is:

1. Water vaporates from lake/river into clouds
2. Water falls down as rain
3. Water falls down either back to lake/river or the ground
4. The ground absorbs water back to underground water.

However that's "smaller" water cycle, as usually clouds can travel vast amount of distance without dropping back, resulting in some water being lost in ocean and vice versa. Now you'd think that means fresh water is a renewable source, but not really. Salty water is, fresh water remains a problem as only around <10% of water worldwide is drinkable. It's also the same water that is used by AI datacentres to cool off, because using salty water would just corrode the equipment. The reason people say water "burns" or gets lost is, any river, lake or any other water bank has an "intake" and "outtake" of water, maybe the knly exception being the swamps. The point is, data centres increase that "outtake" due to water vaporising away to cool off AI data centres. Resulting water can go anywhere from the same place to an ocean, where it's just lost. This leads to a problem that in a while, due to outtake being significantly higher than intake, the entire water bank may be lost.

A real life example of it, albeit due to cotton-farming, is Aral lake/sea. Aral lake/sea had 2 intakes: Amudaria and Syrdaria, however one of them was blocked to water cotton plants, and then in just a decade or two the Aral split into 2 parts and started its desertification. Even now despite lots of progress being made towards fixing Aral, Aral still remains divided as Northern and Southern Aral. AI is basically thousands and thousands of Aral incidents happening worldwide in smaller scale.

People claim that water doesnt get magically "lost" and thats ok for AI centres being this intrusive with fresh water, but all they have is 5th graders basic explanation made for 5th graders, not understanding how water and water cycles truly work and what kind of consequences it will have for humans in the future.

u/LeatherIron4902 • 1 points • 2025-12-26 18:15 UTC

I believe it contaminates hundreds of thousands of fresh water, but I had never heard of it burning up water.

u/RickyRagnarok • 3 points • 2025-12-26 18:07 UTC

They don't mean it in the literal sense. They just mean that it's using up fresh water at an alarming rate.

Similar to how people say someone or something "burns money". They're not literally setting it ablaze. They're just spending it quickly.

u/Anonnnnnnnnnnnnnnm • 1 points • 2025-12-26 18:10 UTC

Ah maybe most mean it that way. My coworker was arguing with people at work saying we'll have no water left when AI finishes burning it up.

u/SphericalCrawfish • 1 points • 2025-12-26 18:22 UTC

Ok, that guy specifically is an idiot.

u/ShaggyX-96 • 3 points • 2025-12-26 18:19 UTC

They are using that saying and basically putting a twist on it. It doesn't mean literal burning water.

There isn't an infinite amount of drinkable water so it is using up a finite source at a growing rate.

u/afcagroo • 1 points • 2025-12-26 18:19 UTC

Your cow orker was dropped on their head too many times as a child.

u/vandergale • 2 points • 2025-12-26 18:07 UTC

After you find this out, please begin your investigation into the combustion of light. I heard someone say that we were burning daylight.
;P

u/Anonnnnnnnnnnnnnnm • 0 points • 2025-12-26 18:12 UTC

Not in the metaphorical sense. My coworker has been arguing with people at work about no water being left when AI is done burning it up.

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-12-26 18:02 UTC

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